

platforms, automation systems, and ChatGPT into workflows to improve communication, operations, speed, and productivity.

R&D is driven by three pillars: product development, process innovation, and continuous value engineering for feature enhancement and cost optimisation. The company operates on a five-acre campus with a 55,000 square feet (5110 square metres) integrated factory-office facility, currently utilising only around 30% of its capacity, leaving significant room for expansion.

How should CXOs prioritise investments across R&D, technology, manufacturing, sales, and branding?

Product cycles have shortened sharply, from 10-15 years in categories such as water heaters and nearly a decade for UPS systems, to just 2-3 years today. SMEs, therefore, cannot sustain long-gestation investments; R&D spending must generate commercially viable outcomes within 1-2 years. Success for them depends on rapid execution, adaptability, and strong market alignment.

SME priorities should remain practical. R&D should focus more on development than pure research, adapting existing technologies into market-ready products through lean teams. Sales is the key growth driver because even strong products cannot scale without effective market coverage, while manufacturing can often be outsourced in electronics. Brand building should progress alongside sales through consistency and trust.

How should companies align sales, distribution, and marketing for long-term growth, and measure true brand value?

Sales, distribution, and marketing should be aligned with how customers prefer to buy rather than forcing a single go-to-market model.

At Hykon, we follow three parallel models—channel sales

Hykon India is a Kerala-based energy and power electronics company operating across inverters, UPS systems, solar water heaters, lithium batteries, and electric mobility. Over the past three decades, it has expanded across rural and urban markets through phased growth and field-driven technology adoption.

through distributors and dealer networks, direct institutional sales for segments such as UPS systems via corporates and government tenders, and project-based sales for customised, end-to-end solutions. The key is flexibility based on customer behaviour.

From a marketing perspective, the real measure of effectiveness is profitability and long-term financial sustainability, not just immediate sales spikes. We track this through structured monthly reviews of sales, expenses, and overall profitability against annual budgets, ensuring disciplined financial control.

For SMEs, marketing is a long-term investment that typically takes 2-3 years to build brand pull, but it should also support operational break-even within about two years.

What role will decentralised energy play in India's future, and how will it grow?

The future of energy is shifting towards decentralisation, where homes and businesses become self-sufficient by combining rooftop solar with local energy storage. We already operate close to this model through a 250kW solar installation that meets most of our operational needs, supported by stored energy for battery charging and testing, bringing us close to a net-zero setup.

What scaling mistakes do Indian tech firms make, and what advice would you give founders building lasting brands?

One common mistake is scaling too quickly without validating market demand. Small flaws

become major risks at scale. The right approach is to start small, gather genuine customer feedback, refine the product, and scale gradually based on proven demand rather than assumptions.

The lesson is clear: infrastructure should follow demand. Start lean, validate profitability, scale step by step, and prioritise disciplined execution over perception-driven growth.

For young founders, success begins with defining a clear five-year vision. Clear goals aligned across the business and teams create focused execution. Long-term success comes from structured planning, consistent review, visualisation, and disciplined action, turning ambitions into measurable outcomes.

What qualities, capabilities, and business models will shape future Indian technology brands?

The next phase of technology will bring rapid but uneven disruption. In the near term, AI will significantly transform software, consulting, recruitment, content creation, medical imaging, radiology, and diagnostics, while hands-on sectors such as plumbing, electrical work, and factory operations will evolve more gradually through robotics and AI integration.

Successful technology brands will continuously monitor disruption cycles, identify sectors with sustained demand, and build adaptable business models aligned with policy and real-world needs. Long-term growth areas such as battery energy storage, electric mobility, UPS systems, and hybrid solar solutions remain attractive because of their role in power reliability, industrial growth, and energy independence. The key capability will be translating long-term societal shifts into scalable, product-driven businesses. **EFY**

This interview is an excerpt of a longer discussion. For the full transcript, please visit: <https://efy.co.in/augint2>

